

SELF-ALIENATION; THE WAY BACK TO THE REAL SELF

Greetings, my dearest, dearest friends. God bless every single one of you. Blessed are your efforts. Blessed is your valiant struggle to find yourself, and thus finding your sense of living.

At this time, which represents for you a new year -- for us, of course, this fragmentation of being which you call "time" is not known -- I should like once again to give you an overall understanding of your current work from an approach that is adapted to your new insights. To do so, let us first understand the human struggle as such. The very state of being human is a problem. It is a problem because you find yourself in an in-between state.

You have awakened from a lower state -- the plant or animal form -- where you were in a state of being and in harmony, but without awareness. But now, you have not yet reached a state of being, you are not yet in harmony, with awareness. This in-between state represents the human struggle as such. This struggle applies not only to those who are on any kind of path of attempting to find the self; it applies to every single human being regardless of his state of development, regardless of what his character and his endeavors are. The only difference between those who actively work toward finding themselves and those who do not is that the former bring this very struggle into awareness, while the latter are unaware of it. Your fight is to find the state of being while in awareness; and with awareness, a proper combination between activity and passivity, between action and inaction, is reached. In this, there is often confusion.

Moreover, the human struggle manifests itself in trying to overcome the obstructions that come from unawareness. And unawareness means unreality, untruth. Untruth produces suffering. In another terminology, it might be expressed as the struggle between the spirit and matter. For matter is a result of unawareness, unreality, untruth. Mastery over matter has been attempted by mankind in many ways. But in the final analysis, it must always mean mastery over untruth -- in you, personally. Only when you become aware of your untruth, not general untruth, can you finally overcome it.

Only as you discover your own unreality (wrong conclusions, pseudosolutions, evasions, etc.) will you reach the core of your being. Slowly but surely, you will begin to act and react from out of this core of yourself rather than out of the superimpositions which are error and distortion. Only when you act and react from this core of your very individuality will you reach and affect the core of others regardless of whether or not they themselves work on such a path. This follows the law of attraction of similar, and repulsion of dissimilar substance, the law of affinity.

Again and again, you search in vain for the real you, the core of your being. You are confused in that you take the superimpositions as the real you simply because you have become so used to them. You may have discovered their destructiveness, their artificiality, but you are as yet unable to

dispense with them. You have not yet gained the sense, awareness, and experience of the real you. You ask yourself, "Who am I? Where is my real self?"

My attempt is to guide you to this core of your nature, from various angles, through various approaches. With this, I can help you, but you have to do the work of recognizing, of facing, of changing. In short, it is your struggle. If you want to become happy, to lead a fruitful, rich life, you have to be whole, undivided. And this can only be if you are your real self. It is logical and reasonable that the struggle and the effort have to be yours if you wish to realize yourself.

The state of self-alienation -- that of not being one's real self -- is so predominant, so general that its symptoms do not stand out. There are many symptoms which pass you by unnoticed simply because they are so general that they are assumed to be "normal."

Let us again look at self-alienation, what it means, and some examples of how it manifests, and how it can be determined. We discussed this already, but I am forever trying new approaches to help you understand.

One way of determining self-alienation is by finding in what areas of life you feel helpless, where you feel trapped in situations outside your control. I pointed out several times that wherever such a state of helplessness exists, there must be an underlying problem, an unresolved conflict. To carry this a step further, I now say that such an unresolved conflict is the result of self-alienation or, as it were, that self-alienation is the result of an unresolved problem. Anyway you wish to formulate it, helplessness, powerlessness, paralysis of one's faculties are the results of self-alienation; and this is intimately connected with unresolved problems that exist in error.

It is very easy to misinterpret these words, particularly if a person has reached the pseudosolution of power. Not to be helpless does not mean that you always win, that you never suffer frustrations, unfulfillments, that things always go according to ideal plans. On the contrary, the person with such a pseudosolution, with the aim of power, is more dependent than most on others and on life. He has to win! His immediate aim has to be fulfilled! If not, he feels weakened and humiliated. Since such fulfillment of every wish, such constant winning, cannot possibly depend on him alone, he is dependent. He invests his own inherent strength in others whom he, consciously or unconsciously, pressures to do his bidding. That which exists in him -- strength, resourcefulness, reason, etc. -- is put outside and not used within, but is used without. This very fact is self-alienation. It leads to as much helplessness as that which befalls the outright submissive, compliant, weak person.

When I say that being your real self will make you master of your life, it means something else than a power driven compulsion always to win out and to never do without that which you wish. It means that, due to a minimum of inner problems, your forces work constructively and productively. They are not paralyzed through inner mismanagement. The richness of your spirit, of your human individuality, will unfold with all its strength. When you find yourself in a difficult situation, you will use your strength to find the inner and outer solution -- for there is always a good solution, all you have to do is see it.

When your experience of self, of others, and of life is not distorted, but in accord with reality, you will express all the benign forces of reason, love, understanding, insight, strength,

resourcefulness, resiliency, flexibility, adaptability, self-assertion, creativity, etc., etc., that your real self is endowed with. You will communicate with others, make yourself understood, express yourself adequately because your real self is free. You will be in a position to discriminate, make choices and decisions because your fear and anxiety are gone. In making a proper and mature choice, you can distinguish between that which is real, valid, constructive and that which is not. With all that, you will find a way out of any difficulty, and the difficulty itself will have been a steppingstone.

You can reach this stage only when nonfulfillment does not annihilate you. Why does it have this effect on you? It is because your experience of self and of others is so distorted that you feel any frustration as a personal rejection and as proof of your inadequacy. You can relinquish only after you fully understand that your worth, your value, your lovability have nothing to do with nonfulfillment. Such nonfulfillment may be the result of your inhibited strength, your real self, but it has nothing to do with your real being. Your real being is simply inactivated by your distorted perception of reality, of certain factors of your life.

The self-estranged person experiences frustration of a wish or of a goal much more than of the unfulfillment itself. In other words, the pain of not having what he wants is much less than the additional factor of receiving proof, as it were, of his worthlessness, inadequacy, unlovability his being nothing. Of course, this is unconscious. In fact, you go to great pain not to be aware of this deduction. You cover it up with the very opposite trends, thoughts, feelings, and attitudes.

Nevertheless, there is a core of you in which you perceive things in just such a way. This accounts for the often disproportionate pain of a failure, a rejection, or lack of success in a particular field. Often it can be rationalized by a truly stringent reality situation; nevertheless, underneath, you will find this connection between your worth and the outer situation. Only after you become aware of this process, of your unreasonable perception of conditions, are you in a position (1) to perceive reality and thus find your real self in this respect; (2) to no longer be alienated from your real self. And only then will you also alter the outer situation.

As you go through this process and gain insight into your distorted sense of reality, along with this insight, your reality sense will be improved automatically. The result of this, inevitably, is that you ascribe less power to outside circumstances than you did before. You feel less helpless as you are able to mobilize your own inherent strength and other faculties that lead to a rich life. The demobilization of these faculties is a result of self-estrangement, which in turn is a result of, and connected with, your distorted experience of life and self; your inability to relinquish; your illusion of being crushed, annihilated, belittled, and worth nothing if certain wishes do not come according to schedule, so to speak.

Your fear of failure is not so acute because of the failure itself, but because it implies, for you, that you have failed because you are inferior. Your fear of responsibility is not so great because of laziness, but because failure to fulfill implies inferiority of your self. Fear of pleasure frustration is not so acute because you cannot live without it, but because it implies an inferiority. Once you see that this is so with you, and really experience this distortion, you will eventually grow out of it. And as you do so, as you perceive and experience these very factors in their reality, you will have access to your real self. You will no longer have to live with a cover of pretense and thus alienate yourself from the core of your individuality. You will realize in you that which had heretofore been only a

potential. This can happen only when you cease living on the periphery and return to the center of your being.

As long as you live on the periphery, you eject your own power outside of yourself. This may happen in the form of an authority you invest with such powers, whether it be an individual or an institution. It may also happen that your own inherent powers are projected simply onto life and fate and "unalterable circumstances," as a whole. You then helplessly await fate's favor, and if it fails to come, the world's injustice and arbitrariness is to blame, not your own error in finding the answer. Your lookout is in the wrong direction. It does not occur to you to look where you might find many solutions. You prefer to remain helpless, thrusting all your own powers, forces, and faculties to the periphery, and thus you are never able to solve anything.

Self-estrangement may and often does exist also in the form of projecting one's own faculties and powers on aspects of the self. Now you may ask that this cannot be because if it is the self, it is not estrangement from the self. It is estrangement from self if faculties, authority, dependency, and strength are projected upon isolated fragments of the personality instead of upon its entirety. If you expect a good rich life -- the solution of your problems and difficulties to come out of only one or just a few of your assets instead of from a harmonious combination of the whole -- you become rigid in this overemphasis. You thereby neglect other faculties and are thus alienated from the self in that an integral part of your entire self is left out of commission.

This holds true even more when you use your various pseudosolutions. If now you reread the lectures dealing with that topic and with the idealized self-image, you will understand what this means in the terms of self-alienation. Your concentration is focused on something that is unreal and unreasonable and, as such, is foreign to the real self whose nature is reality and reason. Moreover, the pseudosolutions and the idealized self are selfish and loveless in their very nature and, as such, are foreign to the real self whose intrinsic nature is love. The pseudosolutions and the idealized self-image are pretenses, while the real self is intrinsically genuine.

Most of you, in the course of this work, have become aware that in some situations you do not function as you do in other areas where you are free from such problems. You are inhibited. You cannot express yourself. You cannot communicate and relate either to others or to yourself. You are confused and anxious. Your faculties are paralyzed. This is not so because you are that way and you cannot help it. It is so because your real self does not function. You are alienated from it due to your unreality, your pretense, your insistence on remaining at the periphery and seeking a "solution" from there.

The person who is not alienated from himself experiences the richness of his own individuality. He experiences his own power. He trusts in himself because he can relinquish and is thus free from compulsion and anxiety. He relates to himself, is in touch with the core of his being, and thus he can relate to others. All this happens without overestimating himself. He does not have to be in glory and perfection, and because of that, he utilizes the infinite richness of his being. It means: "I am strong. My possibilities are manifold and if outer difficulties come to me, I can overcome them, first by facing them fully, then by my willingness to cope with them truthfully, not superficially nor for the sake of appearance. I do not have to be great. I do not have to be glorious or special. I am a simple human being, like many others, but, as such, I am endowed with great powers that I have as yet not realized. These powers cannot express and unfold because of my

unreality, my distorted view. They are in me but can only become manifest when my perception of reality becomes more truthful."

Thus the person not alienated from himself will experience himself. He is equipped to deal with all situations life brings. He will also experience himself in a realistic relationship to the world at large and to other individuals. The alienated person experiences himself as either too small or too big, fluctuating between these two distortions. Other people will either make him feel worthless and dependent, or they will inflate his ego. As is everything else in this respect, this is so subtle that you cannot be aware of it right away. Intellectually, you know better and are utterly unconscious that emotionally you do experience the effect others have on you in that way. It takes a bit of self-accounting and observation in this respect to become aware of what has been in you all the time.

The person who functions from out of his real self will not experience himself as less or more than others. He may observe their shortcomings, but this has nothing to do with feeling superior over them. He may observe in others qualities he is lacking, but this has nothing to do with feeling inferior. The more you feel worthless and as nothing in some hidden crevice of your personality, the more will you tend to overinflate your ego. The less impaired your real ego is, the less will it be necessary to inflate it. And on this depends your relationship to others -- how you perceive them and how you regard yourself in relationship to them.

In the fluctuation of being either more or less than you really are, you are alienated from yourself. You do not experience yourself in your real situation. How then can you experience others in their reality? You may experience certain facets of them which you may overemphasize due to their bringing out the typical lessening or heightening of your personality, as the case may be. In other words, if another appears powerful, strong, invulnerable, and you may particularly desire acceptance of him, he takes on an aura of awe for you that is out of proportion to reality. You are in tension and anxiety with such a person and perceive him in a very distorted way.

Even if your intellectual evaluation may be pretty accurate, your emotional experience is colored by your fears and desires in connection with this person -- even if you have no other aim than in using him to heighten you, to pull you up and out from the inferiority in which you are engulfed. In short, when self-alienation occurs, others affect you according to your own problems. You do not experience them in their reality. Needless to say, you cannot possibly communicate this condition; and such communication is often essential for eliminating an outer problem. In a crass way, a person may experience others as potential enemies or slaves -- as he himself is alternately the one or the other.

How can you enjoy life and rejoice in its richness if your perception is thus beclouded? Only by being yourself are you capable of happiness. This you can now easily see. It requires a great deal of self-observation on your part, on a new level of your emotions, to become aware of these conditions, of this limited outlook and experience -- which, as you know, is the prerequisite for changing your view, your perception, your ability to experience yourself and others in reality. It also requires a certain amount of progress on this path before you can organically proceed to this stage. Entering this realm comes about gradually as a consequence of previous progress. It is so subtle that at first you may not even realize that you have actually entered into such a phase.

But let me assure you, my friends, the moment you experience yourself in your unreality, and you truly see how you do not relate to yourself and to others, how you are alienated from yourself in these particular respects, you approach reality with a greater step than if you try to force yourself into it before you are ready. In other words, here again as always, you first have to fully experience the distortion before you can come out of it. The very fact that you are alive to your unreality is already an important step out of it. You can come in touch with your real self but not before you fully experience how you are as yet not in touch with it. The various ways I indicated by which to determine your self-alienation will help you to experience it.

Take any of your current problems, and look at them from the point of view of how you truly feel yourself victimized, a prey to circumstances and to others. Then observe how you feel frustrated when expressing your wants and your ideas to others. Observe how uncertain and confused you are about the issues and what it is you really want; and consider where you can change things and where you cannot. Have you really explored all the possibilities at your disposal? Are you entirely open for new ideas, new solutions? Is your inner will active to receive new inspiration in order to change an old ill brought on by your own course? Or do you insist that the solution is handed to you? This dependency will show you not only your self-alienation, but also your will to remain that way. Furthermore, observe your emotional reactions to others and how they affect you. Do they make you small or big? Do you experience people as many-faceted complex beings with their own vulnerabilities, their own struggles; or are they for you, emotionally, just more or less, better or worse, more or less powerful than you?

When you feel dissatisfied with your life, ask yourself if this is not due to your feeling that you have not realized all your potentials. If the answer is yes -- and if it were otherwise, you would never feel dissatisfied with your life, regardless of temporary storms -- then you are estranged from yourself. You have the power to change this, step by step, through the procedure of this pathwork.

The word "self-finding" that we use constantly will now take on a new meaning for you. In the true sense of the word, it means the finding of the real self. No such self-finding can occur unless you actively change something in you. Basically this path can be divided into two major phases. One is the phase of recognizing and of becoming aware of the roots of your problems, your errors, your unreality -- understanding them in their full scope and depth, their significance and their causes, effects, links, and connections. And the second phase is that something must change. This change can happen in various ways. It can be a very gradual automatic change you are not even aware of at the moment. It happens through the mere insight into and understanding of your unreality and distortions. The fuller your understanding, the more do you automatically change. Such change is based on the laws of evolution and organic growth.

But there is also another type of change that applies to certain facets of personality problems. This type requires a new and different way of action and reaction after a sufficient amount of insight and understanding has been gained. This change is less gradual but consists of a very decisive and new way of acting, whether outwardly or inwardly. It requires your determination to no longer follow the old pattern of behavior. It requires your will to institute a new pattern. This, however, should never be done as long as you are not fully convinced of its value for yourself and for others, as long as the decision is not fully yours but based on outside authority. But once you have reached this point of conviction, a certain self-discipline has to be used. This, too, is subtle and can easily lead to misinterpretation.

If you use discipline and force without independent decision and full conviction, it comes out of unhealthy motives, and it will not yield constructive results. The motives may be those of obeying and appeasing others and of your own idealized self-image. The result will be anxiety and new destructive patterns. Nevertheless, there comes a point when repeated self-discipline and determination are necessary because, otherwise, in spite of your own free will and understanding, old ingrained habits cannot be uprooted. Whether or not you are ready for this more drastic change, only you yourself can know. As long as your emotions still doubt the validity and advantage of the new way, you are not ready. As long as great anxiety exists in you when trying to dispense with the old way, you are not ready for a forceful relinquishing and a drastic change. Your endeavors must go into the direction of bringing further hidden errors to light. "Why do I feel that way?" will always yield results if you fully want to find the answer. As long as the goodness of the right course fills you with anxiety, you are still under the impression, in this respect at least, that goodness can be to your own disadvantage. In reality, this, of course, is not so. But you have to get to the point of applying this outer knowledge to your specific inner problem. Goodness means productive living.

No real growth and happiness can exist unless a change in the personality takes place. I can read some of your thoughts. Do not say change does not exist. It is so wrong. The universe and everything in it constantly changes, is constantly in flux. Even your body is not the same as it was seven years ago. Everything changes, even in physical matter. You may not notice it, you may not be aware of it. If you are constantly together with a living, growing being, you do not see the growth taking place. You notice it only retrospectively. The very essence of life is change. If there is no change, there is no life. Nothing can remain static. If it does, you are in a predicament. You are unhappy. You are not alive. To a large degree, the human struggle is because a part of you grows organically and healthily according to the laws of nature, while another part remains static.

You often ask the question why do certain people, who obviously are still in a low state of development, live in a certain harmony, while much higher developed people are struggling, disharmonious, unhappy. The reason, my friends, is that the former develop steadily according to their potentiality on an even keel. There is no discrepancy. While the latter often do not realize themselves according to their potential in keeping with their inherent possibilities. Just because they are further up on the scale, they could do so much more. And yet they overemphasize parts of their being which are already developed, that do not need development at this point, while a neglected area of their being has remained static. It does not change because the person does not will it so. He concentrates on that which he enjoys because it is already free, while that which requires work lies barren. It is not only the discrepancy as such that causes the disharmony, but the fact that the person has the ability to accomplish more. He could bring to life what lies dead and static.

It is this factor which is an essential part of the human struggle. If you find growth and change pleasurable because of past development that has already freed you of those particular shackles in this area, you are in constant flux. At the same time, your resistance to change and growth where the hard work of facing and initiating change still has to take place cause you to remain frozen and rigid in another part of your personality. This lopsidedness is more painful to endure than if the entire personality were still asleep, so to speak. Once you have reached certain stages, you cannot possibly make yourself artificially "asleep." You have to follow the rhythm of nature and cosmos. The only solution to reach harmony again is by fuller and fuller awareness of reality, growth, change on all levels of your being.

So do not say change is impossible. It is the only thing that is possible, I might say. It is the only organic, natural process of creation and is therefore also within yourself. If you properly work on this path, you constantly thaw out the substance in your soul that was heretofore frozen. You put it into motion and thus enable it to grow so that eventually a real and noticeable change occurs.

One more thing about the real self, and a further hint as to how to find it -- I want to show you a certain rhythm of development in a certain phase, which is appropriate at this time because many of my friends either are already in this phase or are about to approach it.

We recently discussed your needs. To begin with, you are not even aware of any particular needs. Of course, in theory you know that everyone has needs, physical and otherwise, but you do not emotionally experience any specific emotional needs. This unawareness does not apply only to the person who just begins on such a path, but even after you have already progressed considerably in other ways, this particular lack of awareness may still linger. Only after focusing your attention on this subject will you become aware of some emotional needs. When you ask yourself about the meaning of certain emotional reactions, you first of all find some false needs. At the beginning you are not aware of even this superficial facet. This falsity, too, can be brought into awareness, but only after considerable self-honesty and digging on your part. Now, my friends, if you have to remove outer layers of awareness in order to find false needs before you find the real ones, isn't this another substantial proof of your self-alienation? If you were related to your real self, if you were in contact with its reality, you would be in absolute awareness of your real needs whether or not they are fulfilled.

As you thus proceed, you become aware of your real needs. These real needs can also be subdivided. First, you will become aware of the need to receive -- be it love, be it understanding, be it closeness to others, be it creative fulfillment of your talents. All this you strive for through an act of receiving. In your emotional awareness, it seems to you that you need someone or something that makes it possible for you to fulfill these needs by something, however subtle, that is given to you. (All the needs I cited now can be real or false, you know that.)

And then, you will become aware of the need to give. It may apply to the same needs as stated, but the emphasis in your emotions change. The need to give love rather than to receive it enters more into your consciousness. The need to relate to and to understand others rather than being understood by them and so on, applies also. Here too, you may not find the outlet. You are dependent on finding the subject, and as long as this is not the case, your needs remain unfulfilled. The only difference between now and before is that now you are acutely aware of the needs and the unfulfillment, while before you were befogged and hazy, and you experienced the unfulfillment in an indirect way. The stringent awareness of unfulfillment may in fact have entirely different roots than the unfulfillment of the real needs. For, the latter will never create anxiety and urgency. Only the real needs shifted into false ones have this power. Thus awareness of real needs, long before fulfillment is possible and while you consciously experience unfulfillment, is bound to bring relief, harmony, peace because you have entered a further stage of reality and truth. You run away from awareness of your real needs not only because facing unfulfillment is painful, but more so because unfulfillment means proof of your inferiority.

Once you have reached the strength, courage, humility, determination, and the reality to face your real needs -- to receive and to give out -- and you can stand the temporary frustration, you have reached a much greater area of your real self than you may think. For this is your real self, and your problem of the unfulfillment in itself recedes into the background in importance, in comparison with the strength you gain by finding home -- the stranger finding home within the reality of the core of his being.

To reach this point necessitates many byroads and detours, but once it is reached, you will have to go through a certain period of emptiness, of awareness of your unfulfilled need and longing. But as you look at it, stand it, not in false humility and weakness, but in strength of being able to endure it as long as is required in consequence of the patterns you had set in motion and whose effects have not yet worn off, you will not suffer the agonies you suffered before such awareness. The unfulfillment will not weaken you. On the contrary, through gaining deeper, fuller insight and thus coming closer to reality, you will slowly prepare different effects. Immediately after having found the condition or cause that has produced the negative effect, the old negative effects are not yet dissolved. They are still in force. It will take some time before the new, constructive, positive causes can be in force and produce similar effects. This does not happen overnight.

After a certain period of conscious unfulfillment of real needs, as opposed to previous unconscious unfulfillment of real needs and conscious unfulfillment of false needs, while you learn, search, gain further hold of the reality of yourself, a period of partial fulfillment will occur. There will be setbacks and occasional disappointments in which you have the opportunity to observe your inner relapse into the old patterns which might have occurred without your knowing it. Thus these outer relapses and disappointments are a necessary period of strengthening the new way of life, so to speak, to integrate it, to make it part of you until it becomes your "first nature," as in essence, it truly is.

At this point, you have discovered the way home. You have made some tentative steps toward it -- and therefore occasionally reap the fruits -- but you are still not firmly implanted in this new ground. You still fluctuate away from it, tempted by the old habits. In this alternation between fulfillment and unfulfillment, you have the opportunity to gain a firm hold on your home ground if you wish to utilize this time in such a way. Thus you pave the way to set up an entirely new pattern, a new cause, in health, reality, productivity. The effects will take place until the cause has ripened.

Are there any questions, my friends?

QUESTION: In disciplining yourself when you reach the point when you want to change a pattern because you have made certain recognitions, a battle begins. You may do it, but you don't feel good about it. Although you know you are unhappy in the old way and you want to change, yet in doing the right act, you don't feel good either. Now, I heard you say that in this stage you are not ready, but when are you going to discipline yourself?

ANSWER: In this stage, the discipline should take the form of finding why you cannot feel right about it. What stands in the way of your understanding? There must be something in you that is not yet convinced, that is somehow doubtful that this is good, or advantageous, or safe, or whatever. There must be a part in you that is still convinced of the old destructive way in spite of your seeing it also as destructive. Bring that to the surface, and then you can eliminate the error in

this respect. Therefore do not force yourself or discipline yourself in action toward others, but rather use discipline in finding out more about yourself.

QUESTION: When you suffer grief, when you are separated from someone, and you know this must be, and you accept it, you still suffer deep pain, even more so when you are aware of your own feelings and you are aware of the depth of love you have. This is healthy, is it not? Doesn't it take time to heal?

ANSWER: I cannot answer the question by saying it is either healthy or unhealthy. It depends entirely on how it is felt. It may be something utterly healthy. But it may also contain certain unhealthy currents. It is very hard to determine in a general answer. It is completely individual. My advice is, in order to determine whether or not it is healthy, that the person ask himself where there may be feelings of helplessness, weakness, self-pity, of being subjected to the misery of life. If you feel impoverished, if your personality feels impoverished by such a separation, then there must be an unhealthy grief, perhaps in addition to healthy grief. But if the loss is felt as painful without a feeling of self-impoverishment, then it is purely healthy.

QUESTION: If a human being finds two conflicting currents within, how, if one recognizes the falsity of one current and then the second current kicks in, where does the discipline come in?

ANSWER: As I said before, the discipline, if we call it that -- the use of this very word might lead to misunderstanding -- would have to be used in a different way. It may lead to repression, suppression, to a forceful, superimposed action that cannot be genuine growth. Your concentration and determination should go rather in the direction of further understanding of why this current exists. The outer answer may be quite obvious, and yet there must also be an inner answer having very little to do with the outer one. This current may be some sort of pseudoprotection. It may fulfill a certain false need. Find this meaning, and you will know how to go on from there. The first answer you may find deep within may still not be the final answer. It may still contain a further "why." The stage you describe indicates that the phase of search in this area has not been finished, and therefore change, with its necessary discipline, is premature. Only further awareness has to be looked for here. In another area, a state of change may already have occurred, but not in this respect. I repeat, change takes place constantly in your emotional, mental, spiritual, and even physical organism by such search, by the fact that you face yourself in utter candor. That, too, produces change. But this is the first type of change I discussed and not the second which requires a more direct form of discipline. In this stage, discipline also must exist, but with emphasis on further self-facing, on giving yourself an account of what you really feel and why.

QUESTION: I see. So, as long as two conflicting currents exist, there is still a need to go deeper?

ANSWER: Oh, yes.

QUESTION: I hesitate to ask any questions, owing to the recent stir my questions brought. It seems that they are not considered exactly intelligent. Before I ask my questions, I would like to ask you frankly if you higher developed souls are employing a reason I am not capable of, because unless we are talking on a common ground, I'm afraid we have no means of communication with one another.

ANSWER: My dear friend, in the first place, I do not think anyone can say, if someone does not understand something, that this indicates a lack of intelligence. The most intelligent person, where he has a problem, is blocked. The intelligence that otherwise exists, does not function here. That happens to every single person, to some more obviously than to others, but nevertheless to everyone. There is no human being entirely free of this. I have never yet seen a human being in whom there is not somewhere a tightness, a prejudice, a closeness, a fear of relinquishing a preconceived idea. This, of course, is due to the defense mechanism that chooses a particular view as necessary and safe, but this is only an explanation. It does not do away with the fact as such. In such a case, the person will not understand. He will misinterpret. He will be anxious and conflicted about the issue or will hear the very opposite of what is said. Only the degree differs, and no one should judge because he may possibly have the same condition to a lesser or less noticeable degree, perhaps concerning a different topic. So you are in very good company. You may perhaps put your questions in a more belligerent way, but I do not mind this, and I encourage you to ask these questions as long as you are sincere and in good faith, regardless of what some of our human friends may say. It is necessary. It is good for you. And it is good for everyone.

As to different kinds of reason, there is only one reason. There are not several kinds. Again it is only a question of degree. The difference is that the human being, still finding himself in the human struggle, has his reason impaired. His intelligence may not be impaired, but his reason is. Because reason comes from the real self, and to the degree of his self-alienation, to that degree does reason not function. The real self is pure reason and pure love. You might also call it wisdom. One is not thinkable without the other. There cannot be reason or wisdom without love, and vice versa.

So we all have the same organs to communicate with. If one being has more of it developed than the other due to struggles already overcome, it does not mean that communication is impossible. Communication depends to a very large extent on the willingness of the persons involved. If the willingness to understand and to make oneself understood is present, half of the battle is overcome. I do not think that any of you ever found me difficult to communicate with.

I would then suggest that next time you ask your questions. If all of you have sufficient questions, we might again put in a period for questions and answers.

My dearest friends, all of you, be blessed in spirit, in soul, in body. May these words help you actively to continue your self-realization, to bring out all the wondrous strength, reason, love, creativity, resourcefulness, joy, capacity for happiness that exist in you already. You do not have to grab for it outside. It lies as a treasure within you. Free it from error, evasion, the fear of facing the truth about yourself. Desist from living superficially in the sense of satisfying the world rather than your own standards. Do not live for appearance's sake in whatever area of your life. Live in truth and reality. Face every issue in its entirety. Look at it with objective eyes. Do not hasten over it, and you will find the way home to your real self.

Be blessed. Rejoice in all that is waiting to be liberated in you. You have nothing but joy to look forward to. Soon you may reach the point where the human struggle will be a source of joy, and each step onward will mean further realization of growth and happiness. Be in peace, be in God!

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